

Figure 1: Journal application

quickly take you through its features. F11 toggles between the full screen and window mode. You can choose from a variety of backgrounds and note papers. There is even a square-ruled one to help you draw diagrams. You have a choice of pen colours and widths to give clarity to your drawings and notes. You can also insert typographic text at an arbitrary point on the notepad, allowing you to intersperse hand drawings and typed text. The shape recognition feature converts your squiggled circle into a perfect one. You can even insert a blank space between two sets of handwritten notes and drawings.

"So, I take screenshots of each screen and..." interjected an excited Piyush, but trailed off as he heard Aakash saying: "...and you can export this to PDF." That was it. A projector-friendly application that lets you take free-hand and typewritten notes and export them instantly; he could not have asked for more.

The next hour was spent with an exuberant Piyush rehearsing his role for the meeting by articulating his ideas on a yellow, square ruled paper background with an impatient and hungry Aakash glancing at his watch.

Party time

Monday morning was overcast but Piyush had the sun shining on his face as he strode into the conference room with his clients. The meeting

was very productive with members of the client team taking turns to articulate their ideas and then seeing it appear on the OHP screen. The notes were getting typed on the virtual note pad (remember the typographic text feature) right next to the handwritten block diagrams and flow charts.

The conduct of the meeting was so convincing that an agreement was reached on the minutes, even as they were getting typed. Piyush loaded the exported PDF into his thumb drive as he drafted a formal mail to his clients with the minutes of the meeting as an attachment. As he left the conference room, he overheard one of his clients ask the CEO, "What is that set up you used for this meeting?" The CEO, in turn, looked at Piyush and said, "Remind me later to ask you how you did this..." as he took the clients to lunch.

The sequel

A couple of days later Piyush was busy scanning some annotated sheets to send out as attachments. They were the marketing team's comments to a proposal from the branch office.

"Did I tell you that you can use Xournal to annotate a PDF? Just load the file as background via the 'Journal' menu, annotate it, and

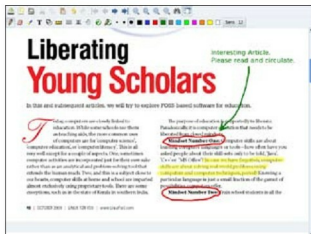


Figure 2: PDF annotation

export it back as a PDF. And you can even annotate files as a meeting activity," said Aakash as he headed for the door. "Makes it so convenient to use with intermediate work products," he continued. Before Piyush could react, Aakash was out of the door and had disappeared into the evening sunshine. "Should remember to get Xournal installed for all staff members with review responsibilities," thought Piyush as he put another page into the scanner. He remembered that OpenOffice.org could export any document to PDF.

Aakash was driving home in the bright evening sun. It was not often that he got to go home when the sun was still up. His project had finally got a higher budget allocation after the CEO had heard of the successful client meeting. He had loaded a couple of new albums on his music player. There was an interesting football match on TV in the evening. Life looked good. 

References

- <http://xournal.sourceforge.net>
- Jarnal <http://www.cklevine.com/general/software/tc1000/jamal.htm> is another annotation program that also supports collaboration.

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